



2025 IMPACT REPORT

Building a more
connected global
reporting system with
impact at its heart.





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FOREWORD

A WORD FROM OUR CEO – ROBIN HODESS

STEADY PROGRESS FOR GRI AND IMPACT REPORTING, DESPITE HEADWINDS



2025 was a challenging year for sustainability. Economic uncertainty, geopolitical tensions, and an evolving regulatory landscape led some to question the pace and priorities of the sustainability agenda. However, the volume of the debate sometimes obscured what was happening on the ground.

Against this backdrop, GRI continued to strengthen sustainability reporting. We launched updated Climate Change and Energy Standards and delivered a corporate pilot for our Biodiversity Standard. We supported SMEs in their reporting efforts and delivered capacity building for stakeholders around the world. We also invested in the future of digital reporting by launching a GRI Standards Taxonomy.

In line with our 2025-2030 strategy, Building Bridges, we worked across the reporting landscape during 2025 to build a more connected global reporting system with impact at its heart. Partnerships with standard setters and frameworks and enhanced interoperability. GRI also shaped the enabling environment, working with policymakers and sustainability organizations from the global to national level. Together, these efforts reinforced the central role of impact materiality in corporate disclosures and strengthened the transparency needed to drive sustainable business and investment.

Our standards are, and must remain, a public good, developed in the public interest to support sustainable development and meet the information needs of a broad range of stakeholders. As reporting becomes increasingly connected and digital, GRI will continue to provide the common language to ensure impact remains at the core of the global reporting system. Equally important is our work helping organizations around the world put standards into practice.

In many ways, 2025 was a crossroads moment for sustainability reporting, one that required new thinking and approaches focused on the value of reporting. The year also marked a shift in how sustainability is understood – moving it beyond compliance and toward resilience, with impact reporting increasingly recognized as a driver of better corporate decision-making.

This shift also reinforced the importance of GRI's mission: to help organizations understand and communicate their impacts on the economy, environment, and people. Delivering on our mission means continuing to strengthen impact reporting, advancing interoperability across the reporting landscape, and supporting preparers and organizations in using sustainability data. By doing so, we can ensure that transparency leads to accountability, action, and a more sustainable future.

GRI IN NUMBERS

GRI REMAINS THE WORLD’S MOST WIDELY USED SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING FRAMEWORK*



4 IN 5

OF THE WORLD’S LARGEST COMPANIES USE GRI



62%

GLOBAL MARKET CAPITALIZATION REPRESENTED BY GRI REPORTERS



107

JURISDICTIONS WITH GRI REPORTERS



2

NEW STANDARDS ON CLIMATE CHANGE AND ENERGY

GRI ADOPTION AROUND THE WORLD

GRI reporting is strongest across South East Asia, Latin America and Africa, reflecting the global shift in sustainability reporting*

PERCENTAGE OF LARGE LISTED COMPANIES USING THE GRI STANDARDS BY REGION



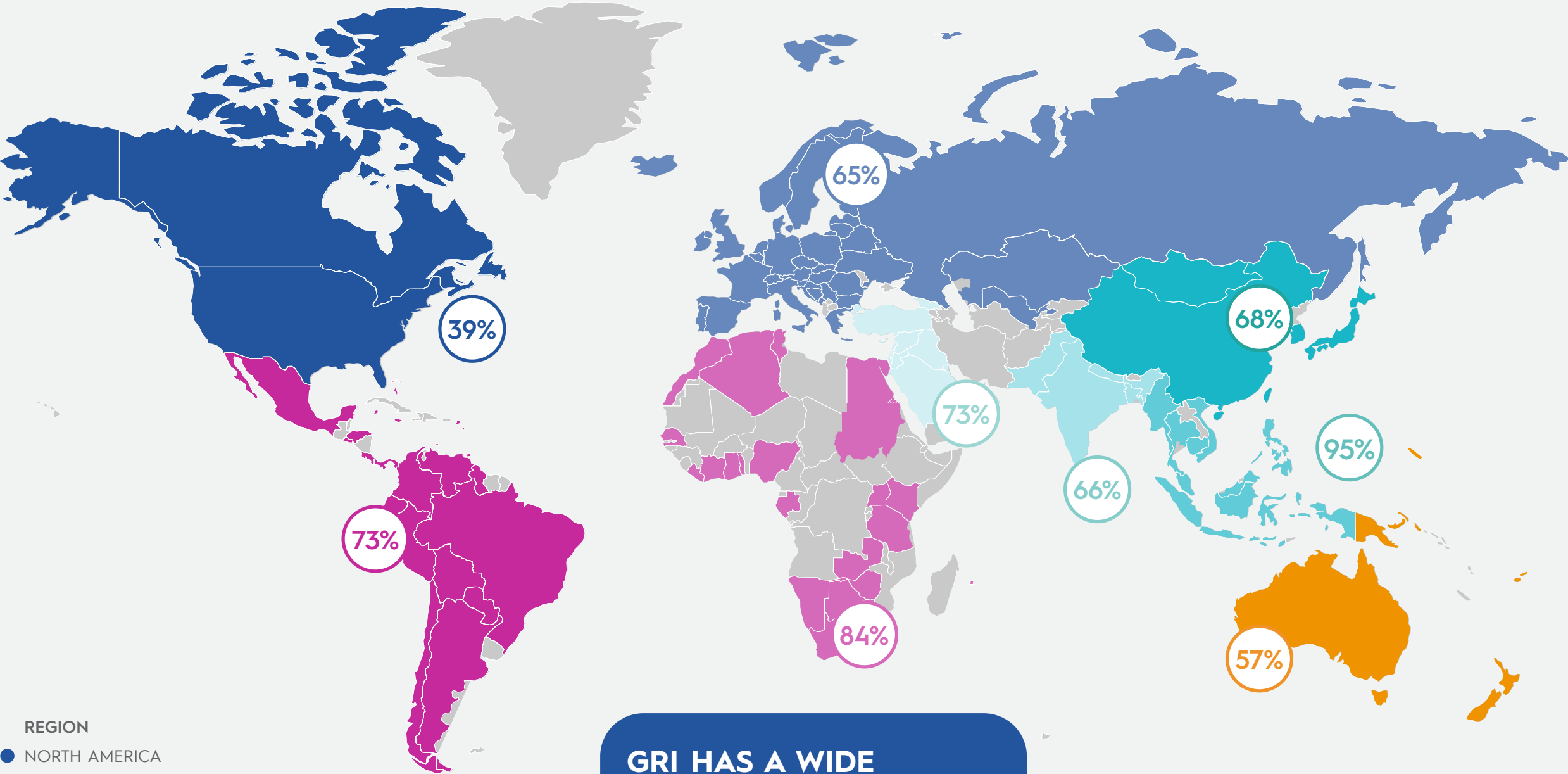
REGION	COMPANIES USING GRI (%)
SOUTH EAST ASIA	62
LATIN AMERICA	61
AFRICA	52
EUROPE	44
WEST ASIA	42
SOUTH ASIA	40
OCEANIA	38
EAST ASIA	34
NORTH AMERICA	23

*“The State of Sustainability Reporting: Global Trends in the GRI Standards 2025”

GRI REACHES THE WORLD’S LARGEST COMPANIES

Companies using GRI account for the majority of market cap across most regions, reaching 95% in Southeast Asia

% SHARE OF MARKET CAPITALIZATION REPRESENTED BY COMPANIES USING GRI.

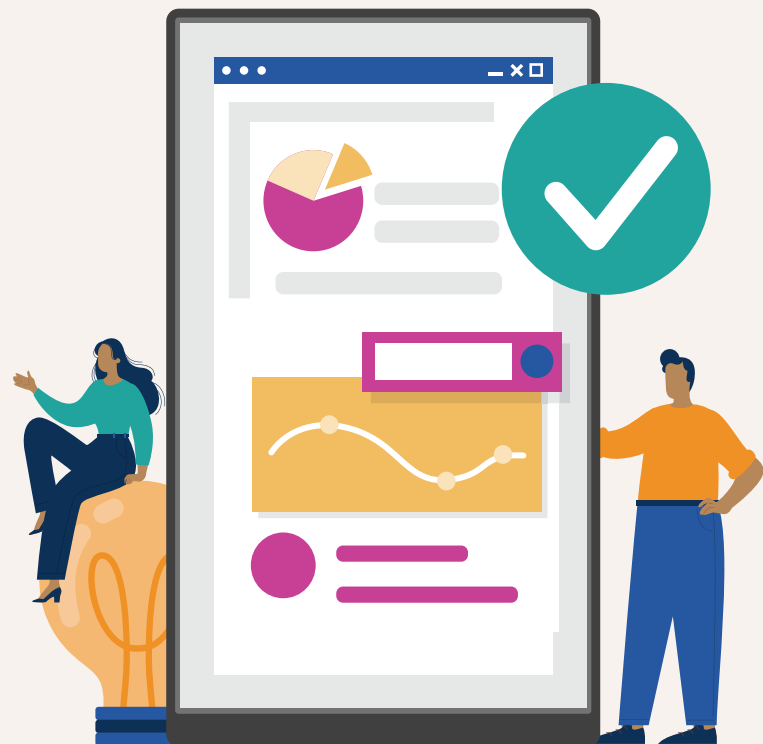


- REGION
- NORTH AMERICA
 - EUROPE
 - OCEANIA
 - EAST ASIA
 - SOUTH EAST ASIA
 - SOUTH ASIA
 - LATIN AMERICA
 - WEST ASIA
 - AFRICA

GRI HAS A WIDE GLOBAL FOOTPRINT

The large and listed companies that use GRI are found in 107 jurisdictions, spanning every region of the world*.

*“The State of Sustainability Reporting: Global Trends in the GRI Standards 2025”



MORE THAN
200
CERTIFIED TRAINING
PARTNERS AND
LICENSED SOFTWARE
PARTNERS



1,900
GRI CERTIFIED
PROFESSIONALS



REPORT SERVICES
USERS ACROSS
49
COUNTRIES

GRI'S STORIES OF IMPACT

Behind the numbers, what was GRI's impact on the ground and around the world during 2025?

Read on for the stories of GRI's standards, programs, and partnerships in action throughout the year.



NEW GRI STANDARDS SET AMBITION FOR REPORTING ON CLIMATE

In 2025 GRI launched revised Standards on climate change and energy, designed to reflect the interconnected nature of climate and nature challenges and to include the human dimension of climate change through a focus on Just Transition. The Climate Standard now contains dedicated disclosures on transition and adaptation planning, greenhouse gas (GHG) reduction targets, and climate-related impacts across value chains.

GRI's standards on emissions and energy (GRI 305 and GRI 302), are among the most widely used GRI Topic Standards. Three in five organizations using GRI refer to them in their reporting. Now updated to take into account improved scientific understanding and international norms, including on carbon accounting (referencing the GHG Protocol), the revised Climate and Energy Standards reflect state of the art disclosures, shaped by GRI's robust multistakeholder standard setting process. [GRI 102: Climate Change 2025](#) and [GRI 103: Energy 2025](#) were officially launched during London Climate Action Week and will come into effect in 2027.

GRI 102 and GRI 103 were downloaded more than 33,000 times in the second half of 2025.

All Standards are [freely available for download](#)

GRI also supported the early implementation of GRI 102 and GRI 103 worldwide, even before the standards have taken effect. This work, focusing on new disclosures related to transition plans and a just transition, included engagement ahead of the 2025 UN Climate Change Conference in Brazil, and a new tool to help organizations align their climate commitments, targets, and transition plans with the UN Integrity Matters recommendations.



The new climate and energy standards marked an important step towards a more connected global reporting system. Accompanying the updated GRI Standards, GRI and the IFRS Foundation issued a joint statement outlining how GRI 102 can be used alongside IFRS S2. This included using equivalent IFRS S2 disclosures for Scope 1, 2, and 3 GHG emissions to meet the corresponding requirements in GRI 102. The aim is to create coherence across sustainability standards, helping preparers streamline reporting.

The GRI and IFRS collaboration also set out how impact reporting and investor-focused disclosures complement one another. GRI 102 focuses on an organization's impacts on the economy, environment, and people, while IFRS S2 focuses on climate-related risks and opportunities that affect enterprise value. Using both Standards together can provide a more complete picture of an organization's impacts, risks, and opportunities.

GRI supported its revised standards with new educational tools. The dedicated GRI Academy course on climate reporting attracted almost 600 enrolments in six months. Focusing on GRI 102 and the IFRS Sustainability Disclosure Standards, the training promotes an integrated approach to climate reporting, spanning impacts on people and biodiversity, GHG emissions, transition plans, and adaptation strategies.



ADVANCING INTEROPERABILITY

Alignment across the global reporting system was embedded throughout the development of the Climate Change and Energy Standards to support consistent concepts, terminology, and definitions. Alongside collaboration with the IFRS Foundation, GRI participated in the GHG Protocol working group to support alignment with the forthcoming revisions to the Protocol. GRI also continued its engagement with the EFRAG on the simplified European Sustainability Reporting Standards. In addition, GRI worked with CDP to support alignment between its 2026 questionnaire and the impact disclosures in GRI 102 and GRI 103.

VOICES OF IMPACT

“GRI’s alignment with the GHG Protocol reinforces a clear message: organizations don’t have to choose between standards. By using a common foundation for emissions data, companies can meet global reporting needs efficiently and consistently. This interoperability helps reduce duplication, increase transparency, and accelerate meaningful climate action. We’re proud to support this step toward a more streamlined, impactful disclosure ecosystem.”

PANKAJ BHATIA
Co-Director at GHG Protocol (WRI)



BIODIVERSITY REPORTING GAINS MOMENTUM WORLDWIDE

Through corporate pilots, research, and global partnerships, GRI helped organizations put its Biodiversity Standard into practice and strengthen connections between biodiversity impacts, risks, and opportunities.

Biodiversity loss is a systemic threat to sustainable development, yet many organizations still lack clear information about their impacts on nature. In 2025, GRI established corporate pilots to help organizations apply [GRI 101: Biodiversity 2024](#) and embed biodiversity considerations in their reporting.

Early adopters showed how organizations can translate GRI 101 into reporting practice. Five participating organizations, including Coca-Cola and Enel, shared lessons from their implementation journeys. Their [case studies](#) explained how they identified and managed biodiversity impacts, providing practical examples for other organizations.

In Latin America, GRI partnered with nuam and PwC to assess the preparedness of listed companies in Chile, Colombia, and Peru to apply GRI 101. [This research](#) found that while 88% of the companies analyzed referred to biodiversity in their sustainability reporting, two-thirds remained at a basic or initial stage of reporting maturity. The findings highlighted opportunities to strengthen disclosures on biodiversity impacts and improve the identification of impacts across the value chain.

Another priority was to help organizations connect impact reporting with the assessment of nature-related risks and opportunities. GRI and the Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures (TNFD) [developed case studies](#) showing how impact assessments can improve an organization's understanding of these risks and opportunities. The examples drew on GRI 101 and the wider suite of GRI Standards related to nature.

GRI, the TNFD, and the Science Based Targets Network also worked with the Nature Positive Initiative to build consensus on [state-of-nature metrics](#). Following a pilot involving 10 companies across North America, Europe, and Asia, the partners contributed to guidance designed to improve the usability of nature metrics and support wider reporting.

VOICES OF IMPACT

“

“We like the clarity and unequivocal way that the GRI standard on biodiversity is written, and the multiple guidance points it sets out. These help organizations like ours understand, interpret, and build knowledge, making the disclosure process smooth and logical.”

”

GALYA TSONKOVA

Head of ESG Reporting & Nature
Programmes, Coca Cola HBC

IMPACT REPORTING GAINS GROUND IN PUBLIC POLICY

Policy developments across China, the EU, and globally demonstrated that reporting on impact features in mainstream corporate reporting systems.

In 2025, GRI helped strengthen a growing international consensus that sustainability reporting should capture sustainability impacts in addition to financial risks and opportunities. China rolled out its new national sustainability reporting standards, requiring organizations to report on impacts, risks, and opportunities, building on related requirements already in place through the country's stock exchanges. Similarly, in Taiwan (China), all listed companies are now required to prepare sustainability reports using GRI Standards.

In the EU, the double materiality approach, which requires the combined disclosure of impacts, risks, and opportunities, remained at the heart of the Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD), despite the Omnibus simplification pressure to alter its scope. Through ongoing [engagement with policymakers and partners](#), GRI helped ensure that impact reporting remained central. As a result, organizations around the world that use the GRI Standards can produce comparable disclosures under the ESRS requirements.

These developments in major individual economies reflected a global direction of travel. The United Nations reached a foundational agreement in 2025, when 192 Member States adopted the [Compromiso de Sevilla](#) outcome document, the first intergovernmental agreement to explicitly recognize both GRI and ISSB Standards and encourage sustainability reporting based on impacts, risks, and opportunities.

GRI's global influence extended to public policy discussions that spilled over into national discussions. In Chile, the country's tax regulations closely align with [GRI 207: Tax 2019](#), meaning that impact disclosures are legally mandated. This development led to broader discussions across Latin America. Working with Pontificia Universidad Católica de Valparaíso, GRI supported the development of a regional evidence base on corporate tax transparency by leveraging GRI 207 to map disclosure practices among listed companies to inform policy uptake across Chile, Colombia, and Peru.

RESEARCH HIGHLIGHTS THE BUSINESS VALUE OF SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING

To address questions about the value of sustainability reporting, GRI helped demonstrate the evidence linking impact reporting and financial performance.

In 2025, GRI published [From impact to income: How sustainability reporting affects the bottom line](#), a research examining the relationship between sustainability reporting and financial value. Analysing 30 peer-reviewed empirical studies, GRI found a consistent link between sustainability reporting and improved financial performance.

Twenty-two of the 30 studies found that sustainability reporting was associated with better financial outcomes. The relationship was particularly strong when organizations used internationally recognized reporting standards, including the GRI Standards.

The research also identified wider benefits, including stronger stakeholder trust, reputational advantages, and improved risk management. Organizations in higher-risk sectors, such as energy, mining, and manufacturing, showed some of the strongest financial benefits. This finding reinforces the value of sector-specific reporting.

Overall, the research found a positive relationship between sustainability reporting and outcomes such as improved access to capital and greater investor confidence. GRI will continue to examine the business case for impact reporting, to build the evidence base of the value of reporting more widely.

BUILDING THE DIGITAL FOUNDATIONS OF SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING

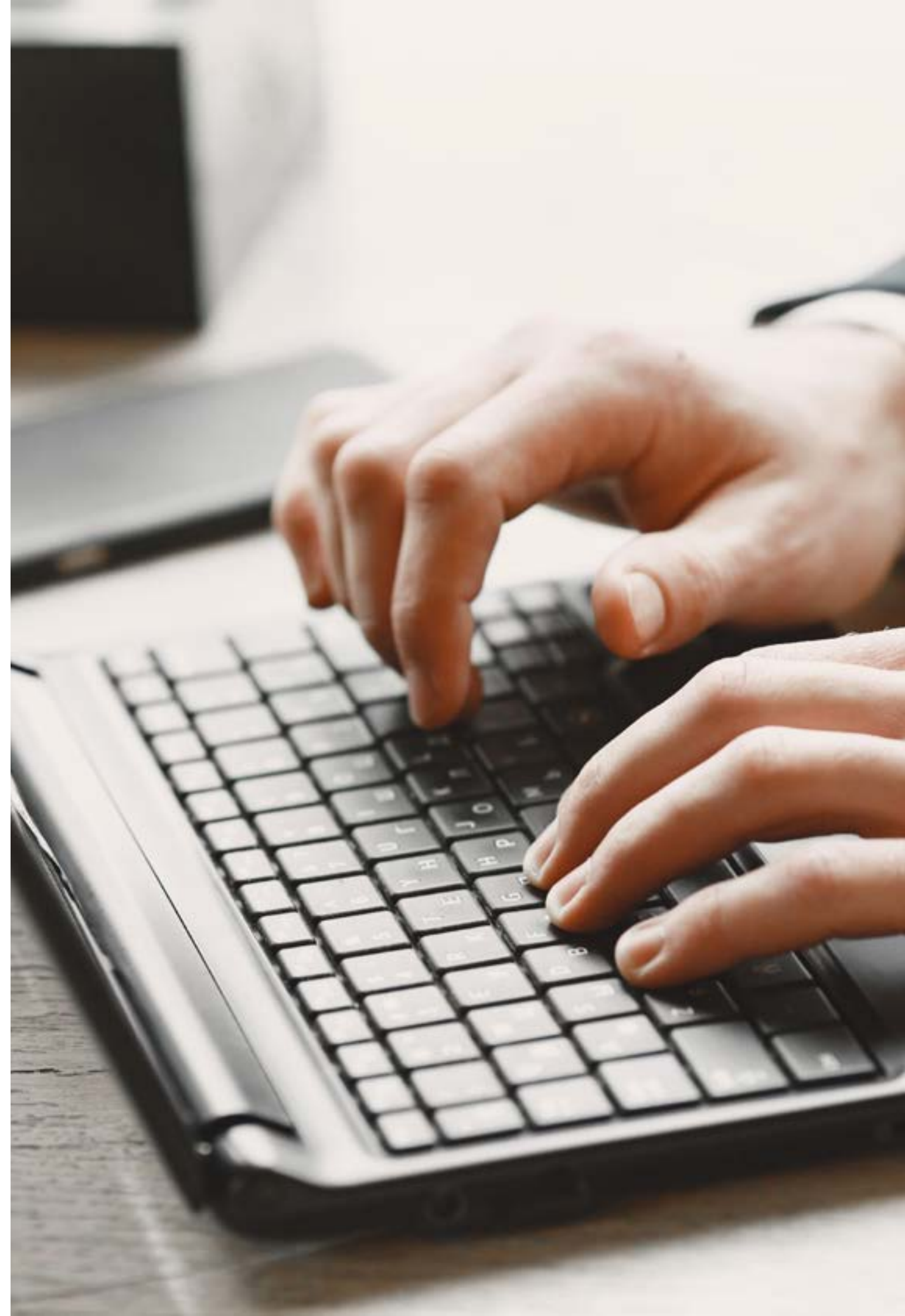
GRI advanced the digital transformation of sustainability reporting in 2025, helping organizations move from static reports to more structured, accessible sustainability information that is optimized for digital use.

A key milestone was the launch of the [GRI Sustainability Taxonomy](#). Built using eXtensible Business Reporting Language (XBRL), the taxonomy enables organizations to make information reported using the GRI Standards machine-readable. This makes sustainability information easier to compare and analyze and helps preparers, regulators, investors, analysts, and other users work with it more efficiently.

The taxonomy supports both digital filing using XBRL and manual submission through a web form. It also allows organizations to describe how they determined their material topics and explain where information has been omitted. These features make the reporting process more transparent and help users understand the basis of the disclosures.

To support the taxonomy, the GRI Academy launched a course: 'Digital Sustainability Reporting Explained'. The course introduces the fundamentals of digital reporting, explains how major sustainability reporting taxonomies work, and shows how digital formats can make information more accessible, structured, and comparable.

GRI also examined how digitalization is changing sustainability impacts and reporting needs. Its paper on the impacts of digitalization highlights issues such as data center energy use, electronic waste, privacy and artificial intelligence. Global e-waste now exceeds 62 million tonnes annually, an increase of 82% since 2010, underlining the need for the GRI Standards to continue evolving.



BUILDING THE SKILLS BEHIND BETTER SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING

As sustainability reporting requirements continued to evolve, GRI helped reporters, organizations, and partners build the knowledge and skills needed to keep pace.

In 2025, GRI expanded its education, certification, partner training, and community programs to make sustainability reporting more accessible, practical, and effective.

The [GRI Academy](#) strengthened its online learning portfolio in 2025, with six new courses:

- Climate Reporting with GRI and IFRS Standards
- GRI-TNFD Interoperability
- Leveraging the GRI Taxonomy for GRI Reporters
- Reporting on Scope 3 Emissions
- Digital Sustainability Reporting Explained
- Sustainability Impacts and Risks.

GRI also expanded access to instructor-led training through its global network of [Certified Training Partners](#). By delivering courses in local languages and using regional case studies, partners made reporting knowledge more relevant and practical. Kazakhstan joined the network for the first time, while partners made 13 new licensed courses available, compared with five in 2024.

TOP 3 COURSES COMPLETED IN 2025

COURSE	LEARNERS
REPORTING WITH THE GRI STANDARDS	1,272
REPORTING ON HUMAN RIGHTS WITH THE GRI STANDARDS	1,207
DECODING THE SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING LANDSCAPE	980

FEEDBACK FROM ACADEMY LEARNERS:

REPORTING WITH THE GRI STANDARDS:

"A clear and well-structured overview of the GRI Standards, with a logical explanation of the reporting process and materiality requirements. It is easy to follow, and the case studies were useful in illustrating how the Standards are applied in practice."

DECODING THE SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING LANDSCAPE:

"Comparing GRI with other international standards has increased our knowledge and confidence in decision-making within the company where I work."

NAVIGATING THE GRI SECTOR STANDARDS:

"The use of different characters to ask pertinent questions about real life scenarios helped me understand my organization perspective in a better way."

CLIMATE REPORTING WITH GRI AND IFRS:

"This course clearly distinguished between GRI's impact-focused approach and IFRS S2's financial materiality – helping me understand why organizations need both."

EXPANDING CERTIFICATION PATHWAYS

In response to learners' needs, GRI updated the GRI Professional Certification Program in 2025. Two courses covering the GRI Sector Standards and the wider sustainability reporting landscape were added. Reflecting changes in the EU regulatory environment, GRI also launched the ESRS Professional Certification Program and updated its content in line with European Commission amendments.



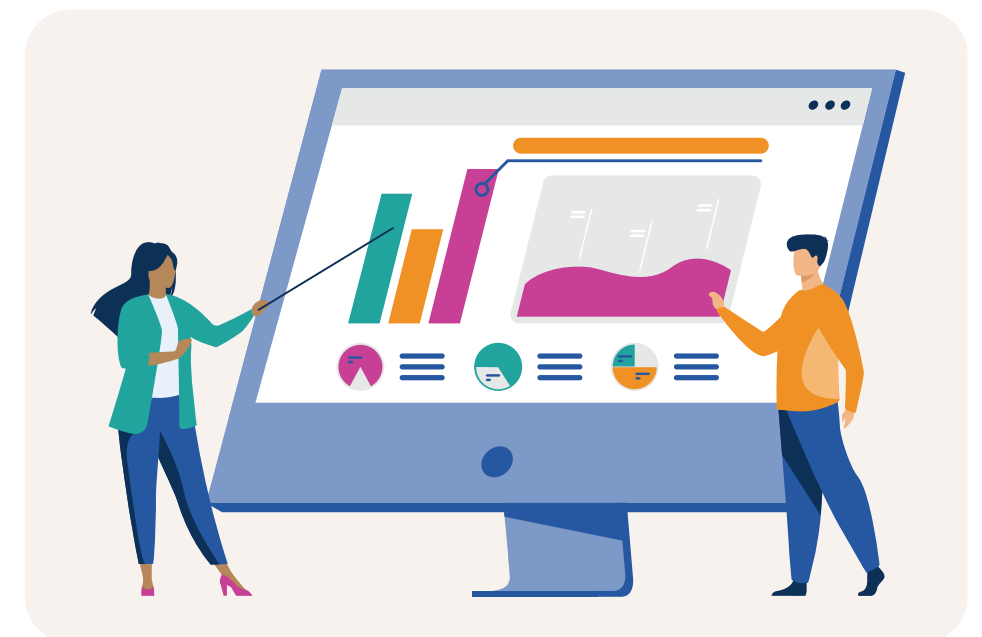
Beyond education, GRI developed and implemented a new verification methodology for [Licensed Software and Tools Partners](#). Tailored to different platform types and use cases, the methodology introduced specific criteria, updated internal guidance, and verification toolkits. These changes supported more consistent assessments and helped partners support organizations in producing high-quality disclosures.

Through [Report Services](#), GRI supported 300 organizations in improving the quality, compliance, and accessibility of their sustainability reporting. Services included Content Index Services, an SDG add-on, GRI-ESRS Linkage Services, and tailored guidance for organizations moving from reporting with reference to the GRI Standards toward reporting in accordance.

GRI also supported organizations through engagement and peer learning. In 2025, the GRI Community team delivered 16 online events for more than 600 participants worldwide. Topics included ESG management, climate reporting, interoperability, and artificial intelligence.

The [GRI Community](#) also delivered two Communities of Practice: the State of Nature Metrics pilot and the Climate and Energy program. Together, they brought together 60 participants from more than 25 reporting organizations. These groups helped organizations test emerging approaches, discuss implementation challenges, and share best practices.

4.7
RATING BY
★ Trustpilot



GLOBAL STANDARDS THAT RESPOND TO LOCAL NEEDS

GRI's focus has always been global – to ensure relevance, consistency and comparability in reporting that spans markets and borders. Yet implementation of the Standards takes place more locally.

GRI Regional Networks around the world supports and collaborates with a diverse range of stakeholders, partners and organizations, to drive both the uptake and the use of sustainability reporting.

In 2025, that included adding to GRI's regional presence through representation in Vietnam and China, and a continuation of programs to engage SMEs in using the GRI Standards to meet their transparency needs and requirements in Africa, Latin America, South and Southeast Asia.





BUILDING REPORTING CAPACITY ACROSS LATIN AMERICA’S AGRICULTURAL VALUE CHAINS

GRI and the U.S. Soybean Export Council helped companies across Latin America use sustainability reporting to strengthen decision-making, stakeholder engagement, and competitiveness across agricultural value chains.

GRI’s work spans every region, and 2025 brought clear examples of its global reach. In Latin America, GRI partnered with the U.S. Soybean Export Council (USSEC) to strengthen reporting capacity across agricultural value chains. The initiative helped companies move from general sustainability awareness toward practical, reporting-led action.

GRI and the USSEC found that companies connected to U.S. sustainable soy lacked clarity on how to identify their most significant impacts on the economy, environment, and people, and connect those impacts with stakeholders.

Together, the partners delivered workshops across Latin America for participants from across the value chain. They included procurement, commercial, and client management teams, as well as senior leaders from importing, processing, and end-user organizations. This broad participation reflected the cross-functional nature of both sustainability reporting and supply chain management.

The workshops used [GRI 13: Agriculture, Aquaculture and Fishing Sectors 2022](#) to explain the value of reporting, how to determine material topics, and how to address sector-specific issues such as climate resilience, biodiversity, and labor rights. Interactive case studies and group exercises supported practical learning.

The workshops reached around 100 participants from 60 companies across 11 countries: Colombia, Costa Rica, the Dominican Republic, Ecuador, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, Jamaica, Mexico, Panama, and Peru.

The program helped participants understand materiality as a decision-making tool. This shift positioned reporting as a way to improve prioritization, strengthen internal alignment, engage stakeholders more effectively, and support business competitiveness.

VOICES OF IMPACT

“Building the capacity to generate trust is strategic. Working with GRI allows us to provide companies with a professional and corporate approach to sustainability strategy. Each reporting element shapes a roadmap for managing stakeholder relationships and guiding corporate action toward sustainability.”

LUIS BUSTAMENTE,
Sustainability Lead
at USSEC Americas



SUPPORT FOR A SUSTAINABLE TEXTILE AND APPAREL SECTOR IN SOUTH ASIA

GRI brought companies and stakeholders together across South Asia to build reporting capacity and strengthen transparency throughout textile and apparel value chains.

In 2025, GRI South Asia co-led the [Improving Transparency for Sustainable Business](#) program, which brought together stakeholders in India, Bangladesh, and Sri Lanka to strengthen sustainability and impact reporting across the textiles and apparel sector.

Delivered with NTUC LearningHub, a continuing education and training provider based in Singapore, the program reached more than 750 participants through regional and national activities. These included country launches, technical consultations, and stakeholder dialogues.

Supported by the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency, the program provided targeted capacity building for more than 100 textiles and apparel companies, ranging from multinational enterprises to small and medium-sized enterprises.

This initiative strengthened sector-wide collaboration and policy dialogue while promoting internationally recognized reporting practices through practical capacity building. In Sri Lanka and Bangladesh, it also gained national-level backing, bringing together public and private sector stakeholders to improve transparency across value chains and support a more resilient and competitive sector.

SMES USE SUSTAINABILITY DATA TO UNLOCK VALUE IN SOUTHEAST ASIA

Small and medium-sized enterprises across Southeast Asia showed how sustainability reporting can support business growth by improving access to finance and supply chains and strengthening customer relationships.

In 2025, GRI supported micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises across the Association of Southeast Asian Nations through its SME program. The initiative helped companies use sustainability reporting to strengthen their business practices and competitiveness.

Through training and technical support, participants built the skills to communicate their impacts and practices to customers, lenders, and business partners. This helped them respond to evolving transparency expectations.

Participating businesses reported practical benefits, including stronger customer relationships, improved internal processes, and better access to finance and supply chains. One enterprise used its sustainability report to secure funding that enabled it to grow from a microenterprise into a small enterprise.

The ASEAN SME program showed how greater transparency through GRI reporting can create business opportunities while supporting more sustainable and inclusive economic development across the region.



HELP FOR AFRICAN SMES TO BUILD RESILIENCE THROUGH REPORTING

In 2025, GRI expanded a program helping African SMEs strengthen sustainability reporting, meet local requirements, embed more sustainable business practices, and build resilience.

IGRI Africa expanded the Enhancing SME Sustainability Reporting and Business Practices program, engaging more than 150 small and medium-sized enterprises across Ghana, South Africa, Zambia, and Zimbabwe.

Supported by the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency and the Swiss State Secretariat for Economic Affairs, the program aims to reach 500 SMEs in the mining, agriculture, and manufacturing sectors. It helps participants strengthen sustainability reporting and embed more sustainable business practices.

During the year, GRI Africa worked with local consultancies and business support organizations, including Sustainable Climate Care For All Africa, Wiggle Ventures, and ESG Africa Network Zimbabwe. These partners delivered practical training on the GRI Standards and helped build regional networks for implementation.

GRI Africa also mapped national sustainability reporting requirements and sector certifications in Ghana and South Africa against the GRI Standards. This work helps SMEs understand how they can use a single global framework to meet local requirements and supports the development of integrated digital reporting tools.

Through these activities, GRI aims to support 100 SMEs in publishing sustainability reporting aligned with the GRI Standards by 2028.





CLOSING

FROM TRANSPARENCY TO LASTING IMPACT

GRI unlocked value from reporting in many ways in 2025, connecting global sustainability reporting standards to practical and meaningful action.

Standards on climate change, energy, and biodiversity strengthened reporting on a global scale. GRI’s training, regional engagement, implementation support, policy engagement, and research helped demonstrate how reporting can improve decision-making, build trust, strengthen resilience, and create business value.

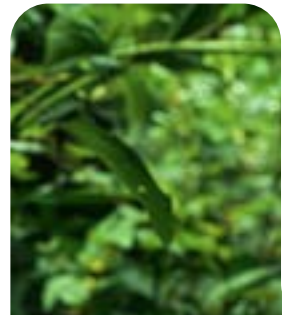
Together, these activities reinforced a central principle: effective reporting depends on more than standards alone. Organizations need a coherent approach that connects information about their impacts to related risks and opportunities, in ways that respond to the needs of their stakeholders.

During 2025, GRI collaborated with standard setters, partners, policymakers, businesses, and other stakeholders to improve interoperability and reduce duplication. This alignment supported progress toward a more streamlined global sustainability reporting system in which impacts on the economy, environment, and people remain central.

At the same time, GRI invested in the people and infrastructure behind reporting, leading outreach via its Regional Networks, the GRI Academy, GRI Community, as well as other support services and partner programs.

As expectations for corporate transparency continue to evolve, GRI’s role remains clear: to provide a trusted global language for organizations to understand and communicate their impacts. For GRI, impact reporting is ultimately about much more than disclosure





KEEP IN TOUCH



2025 IMPACT REPORT

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

PROJECT MANAGEMENT
Catherine Sharp-Aouchiche
Stefano Giacci

EDITORIAL DEVELOPMENT
Steve Gillman
Tom Whittles
Karina Minich

GRAPHIC DESIGN
Juliana Duque Gennrich

PHOTOS
GRI archive
Pexels

ICONS
The Noun Project

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